

The Psychic Researcher

Nerve +3 | Notice +2 | Rapport +1 | Reason +4 | Vigor +0

You are **The Psychic Researcher**. You study clairvoyance, precognition, and anomalous perception through controlled experiments. You want psychic phenomena to be real, but every case you have examined has collapsed under scrutiny, produced inconclusive results, or could not be repeated. When invited to join the investigation of Mourning Bluff Manor, you accepted the opportunity to observe a reputed haunting firsthand. You are not there to communicate with the dead or explain away what happens. You want to determine whether genuine psychic phenomena can be measured, repeated, and quantified.

WHAT IS ESTABLISHED

You approach anomalous experiences as evidence rather than revelation. You are not here merely to debunk the haunting or commune with it; you want results that can be recorded, compared, and repeated. Your equipment and expertise are real even if your field is treated with suspicion. Your name, age, gender, appearance, occupation, relationships, and personal history are yours unless established above.

MAKE THE CHARACTER YOUR OWN

Choose the discipline that brought you here: psychology, neuroscience, statistics, parapsychology, anthropology, engineering, or independent research. Decide who funds your work, what professional failure still follows you, and whether you secretly need the house to prove you right. You may be warm with subjects, clinically distant, or trying to become better at seeing the people behind the data.

DECIDE BEFORE PLAY

- What previous experiment came closest to convincing you?
- Who would take your findings seriously if you returned with proof?
- Which person here are you most tempted to treat as a research subject?

WEAKNESS: NO BASELINE

I trust observation over instinct, and I need to see someone else's response before I commit myself.

If you make the first test in a room, discard your visible Premonition without revealing the next card and make that test blindly.

After the test resolves, reveal a new Premonition normally.

GIFT: EXPECTED VALUE

I do not need certainty; I only need the most likely outcome.

Once per room, before making a test, you may use a test value of 8 instead of using your Premonition. Add the relevant Stat normally.

This result has no suit or special card effect. Your Premonition remains visible and in place.

TOOL: ENVIRONMENTAL DATA LOGGER

You carry a rugged black data logger about the size of a paperback book, with rubberized corners, a small green display, several blinking indicator lights, and a bundle of wired sensors clipped to its case. Its internal clock continuously records and timestamps temperature, air pressure, vibration, sound, and electromagnetic activity.

When something apparently supernatural happens, you may examine the logger. The GM tells you which measurements changed and which remained physically normal. The logger records physical conditions, not their cause, and a phenomenon may leave no measurable trace.

SECRET

Create a Secret that your character must hide from the rest of the group. It should be something that could cause conflict if the others discovered it.

QUICK PLAY REFERENCE

Tests. Use your active Premonition, add the named Stat, and compare the total with the Difficulty. Beat it by 3 for a clean success; meet it or beat it by 1-2 for success with a consequence; below it fails. Minor cards. Ace: critical success and regain 1 Grounding. Page 11. Knight 12. Queen: automatic success and lose 1 Grounding. King: critical failure and lose 1 Grounding.					Major Arcana. A Major is never a test value. It changes the whole house, then every character resets their Premonition. Grounding. Begin with 6. At 0, you are Unmoored and draw blindly until an Ace or meaningful help in a place of safety restores you. Tools. Use your Tool in any physically reasonable way. No test is needed when it makes the outcome safe and certain.
NERVE Endurance, courage, and sanity	NOTICE Perception and awareness	RAPPORT Charisma and social influence	REASON Intelligence, knowledge, and willpower	VIGOR Strength, dexterity, and athletics	